

Bank of Leeds Strategic Investment Proposal

Yorkshire Alpine Resort Development Programme 2050

Establishing Britain's Premier Four-Season Mountain Resort

Prepared for:

Bank of Leeds

Strategic Infrastructure, Tourism & Regional Development Division

Investment Classification:

Strategic Tourism Infrastructure • Hospitality • Leisure • Commercial Property • Regional
Economic Development

Proposed Investment Vehicle:

Yorkshire Alpine Development Corporation (YADC)

Indicative Capital Programme:

£1.2 Billion

Investment Horizon:

30 Years

Executive Summary

The Bank of Leeds proposes the creation of the **Yorkshire Alpine Resort**, a purpose-built, four-season mountain resort situated on the southern gateway to the Yorkshire Dales, between **Skipton** and **Bolton Abbey**.

Unlike existing indoor ski centres, the Yorkshire Alpine Resort would combine winter sports, luxury hospitality, outdoor recreation, heritage rail, conference facilities and Yorkshire food and drink into a single destination capable of attracting visitors throughout the year.

The proposal is designed to address a longstanding gap in Britain's tourism economy. While the UK has internationally recognised heritage cities, national parks and coastal destinations, it lacks a comprehensive Alpine-style resort that integrates accommodation, leisure, conferences and family recreation in a single location.

The Yorkshire Alpine Resort would become:

Britain's largest integrated mountain resort and one of the flagship tourism destinations of Northern England.

Strategic Rationale

Yorkshire already possesses many of the ingredients required for a world-class leisure destination:

- The Yorkshire Dales National Park.
- Bolton Abbey Estate.
- Skipton's established tourism economy.
- Strong motorway and rail access from Leeds, Manchester and Bradford.
- Existing heritage rail infrastructure.
- An internationally recognised food and hospitality sector.

However, these attractions currently operate independently.

The proposed resort would integrate them into a single visitor economy capable of generating year-round demand.

Proposed Location

Preferred Development Zone

Southern Yorkshire Dales Gateway

Between:

- Skipton
- Bolton Abbey
- Embsay

This location offers:

- proximity to the proposed Bolton Abbey heritage railway expansion,
 - direct access to walking and cycling routes,
 - excellent road connectivity via the A59 and A65,
 - a setting that naturally complements Alpine-inspired architecture.
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Development Vision

The resort is conceived as a **new village**, not a single building.

Architecture would draw inspiration from:

- traditional Yorkshire stone construction,
- Alpine timber detailing,
- Victorian railway heritage,
- contemporary sustainable design.

The development would include:

- pedestrian streets,
- landscaped public squares,
- water features,
- woodland,
- cafés,
- artisan workshops,
- public gardens.

Capital Investment Programme

Total Investment

£1.2 Billion

Component	Investment
Indoor mountain & snow complex	£300m
Hotels & accommodation	£220m
Alpine village & retail	£120m
Conference & events centre	£100m
Adventure & outdoor facilities	£90m
Transport infrastructure	£120m
Utilities & renewable energy	£70m
Landscaping & public realm	£60m
Contingency	£120m

1. Yorkshire Indoor Mountain

Investment

£300 Million

The centrepiece of the development.

Features:

- Britain's largest indoor ski slope.

- Multiple pistes for beginners and advanced skiers.
- Snowboard terrain park.
- Freestyle competition zone.
- Children's snow village.
- Ice climbing wall.
- Snow play park.

Capacity:

Approximately **6,000 visitors per day**.

2. Yorkshire Alpine Village

Investment

£120 Million

Construction of a permanent village containing:

- boutique hotels,
- restaurants,
- cafés,
- artisan bakeries,
- Yorkshire food hall,
- independent retailers,
- local craft workshops.

Design principles:

- Yorkshire stone,
 - timber façades,
 - slate roofs,
 - landscaped courtyards.
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3. Luxury Accommodation

Investment

£220 Million

Develop:

Alpine Grand Hotel

- 300 rooms

- spa
- wellness centre
- conference suites
- rooftop restaurant

Alongside:

- 200 luxury woodland lodges
- family chalets
- serviced apartments

Projected occupancy:

Approximately 72% annually.

4. Yorkshire Adventure Park

Investment

£90 Million

A complementary year-round attraction featuring:

Summer:

- mountain biking,
- climbing,
- zip lines,
- high ropes,
- alpine coaster,
- hiking.

Winter:

- skating,
 - curling,
 - snow tubing,
 - winter festivals.
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5. Conference & Business Centre

Investment

£100 Million

Facilities include:

- 3,000-seat conference hall,
- exhibition space,
- meeting rooms,
- innovation centre.

Target markets:

- corporate events,
 - trade exhibitions,
 - university conferences,
 - professional associations.
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6. Heritage Railway Integration

Investment

£50 Million (within transport allocation)

The resort would integrate directly with the proposed **Bolton Abbey Heritage Railway**.

Visitors arriving by steam train would enter the resort via a restored station designed in Midland Railway architectural style.

Packages would combine:

- heritage rail journeys,
 - hotel stays,
 - winter sports,
 - dining experiences.
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7. Sustainable Energy Programme

Investment

£70 Million

The resort would seek to minimise operating costs through:

- rooftop solar generation,
 - ground-source heat pumps,
 - battery storage,
 - rainwater harvesting,
 - high-efficiency refrigeration systems,
 - district heating.
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Financial Model

Visitor Forecast

Year	Visitors
Opening	1.8 million
Year 5	3.2 million
Year 10	4.5 million

Revenue Streams

Source	Annual Revenue
Winter sports	£95m
Hotels & accommodation	£80m
Restaurants & hospitality	£60m
Retail	£55m
Conference centre	£35m
Adventure activities	£50m
Events & festivals	£30m

Total Annual Revenue

Approximately £405 Million

Operating Costs

Estimated annual operating expenditure:

£240 Million

EBITDA

Estimated:

£165 Million per annum

Economic Impact

Construction

Estimated:

- 12,000 construction job-years.
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Permanent Employment

Sector	Jobs
Hospitality	1,500
Leisure	900
Retail	700
Conference & events	400
Facilities management	300
Administration	200

Total Permanent Jobs

Approximately 4,000

Regional Economic Impact

The resort is expected to stimulate:

- increased visitor spending across Skipton and the Yorkshire Dales,
- hotel demand,
- food and drink production,
- heritage attractions,
- transport services,
- local supply chains.

Estimated wider regional economic impact:

£650–750 Million annually

Financing Structure

Yorkshire Alpine Development Bond

Bond Issue

£1.2 Billion

Source	Amount
Bank of Leeds	£500m
Pension Funds	£250m
Institutional Investors	£250m
Private Hospitality Partners	£200m
Bond term:	

30 years

Delivery Programme

Phase One (Years 1–4)

Investment:

£350m

Deliver:

- land acquisition,
 - infrastructure,
 - indoor mountain.
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Phase Two (Years 4–7)

Investment:

£450m

Deliver:

- hotels,
 - Alpine village,
 - conference centre.
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Phase Three (Years 7–10)

Investment:

£400m

Deliver:

- transport integration,
 - adventure park,
 - renewable energy systems,
 - landscape completion.
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Strategic Benefits

The Yorkshire Alpine Resort would:

- establish Yorkshire as Britain's premier four-season leisure destination;
 - complement nearby attractions including Bolton Abbey, Skipton Castle and the Yorkshire Dales;
 - support domestic tourism while attracting international visitors;
 - create a substantial year-round employment base in North Yorkshire;
 - provide a flagship commercial asset capable of generating long-term investment returns.
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Risk Assessment

Risk	Mitigation
High capital costs	Phased development with milestone-based investment
Competition from European ski holidays	Focus on short breaks, families, corporate events and year-round attractions
Energy costs	Extensive renewable generation and efficient building systems
Seasonality	Four-season business model with conferences, festivals and outdoor recreation
Planning and environmental constraints	Early engagement with planning authorities and a brownfield-first site selection where feasible

Final Recommendation

The Bank of Leeds should establish the **Yorkshire Alpine Development Corporation (YADC)** to lead planning, financing and delivery of Britain's first integrated Alpine-style mountain resort.

The proposal should be developed through a partnership between private investors, local authorities, tourism businesses and transport operators, with phased investment tied to commercial milestones and environmental approvals.

Investment Thesis

The Yorkshire Alpine Resort is conceived not as a conventional ski centre, but as a strategic regional development project capable of reshaping Yorkshire's visitor economy.

By combining leisure, hospitality, heritage, business tourism and outdoor recreation in a single destination, the resort would create a year-round economic engine for the Yorkshire Dales while strengthening Yorkshire's national and international tourism profile.

Its long-term objective is straightforward:

To establish Yorkshire as the home of Britain's premier mountain resort and create a landmark destination that delivers sustained employment, private investment and regional economic growth for decades to come.